REMEMBRANCES *From Our* 20TH REUNION

Planning reunion a nostalgic journey

Nostalgia sets its own pace in each person, making some long to revisit the good old days sooner — or later — than others. For example, take **Shawna McDonough** from Willowbrook High School Class of 1976, who has a hand in planning its 20-year reunion.

"I didn't go to our five- or 10-year reunions, and mentioned to a few people that I wanted to go to the 20th. But no one was doing it," McDonough said.

"So, over dinner one night, **Maureen Osborne** and I decided that we would organize the reunion and recruit help from those who worked on the 10-year. When we called them, they practically hung up on us because reunions are so much work," she said with a laugh. "They wanted tickets for it, but that's all."

However, McDonough and classmate Osborne persevered, cajoling a few more alumnae to lend a hand for some serious reunion planning.

"Starting with information from the 10-year, we cross-referenced names, went through phone books, and thought the list was pretty well updated after spending three weeks on the telephone," McDonough said. "Last January, we sent a mailing to 800 people."

McDonough says that those who now live farthest from Villa Park gave the most enthusiastic responses to the gathering scheduled for Aug. 31.

"Especially if they hadn't seen anybody for awhile, they thought a reunion would be a blast," she said.

"We're counting on at least 250 showing up," she said.

Because of her experience, McDonough has some advice for reunion strategists: Keep your planning committee small.

"We find that a small committee works well because decisions can be made more quickly. Maureen is organized and on top of everything," she said, adding that classmates **Gail Skrzypek Stockton**, **Tina LaBella Kalbfleisch** and **Wendy Bowdish Flynn** help by doing computer work, keeping track of money, and providing printing services.

"Also, you need money for postage, deposits on the banquet hall, disc jockey and photographer," she said, indicating that personal cash outlays make planners even more anxious for a good response from classmates.

For details, call [redacted].

